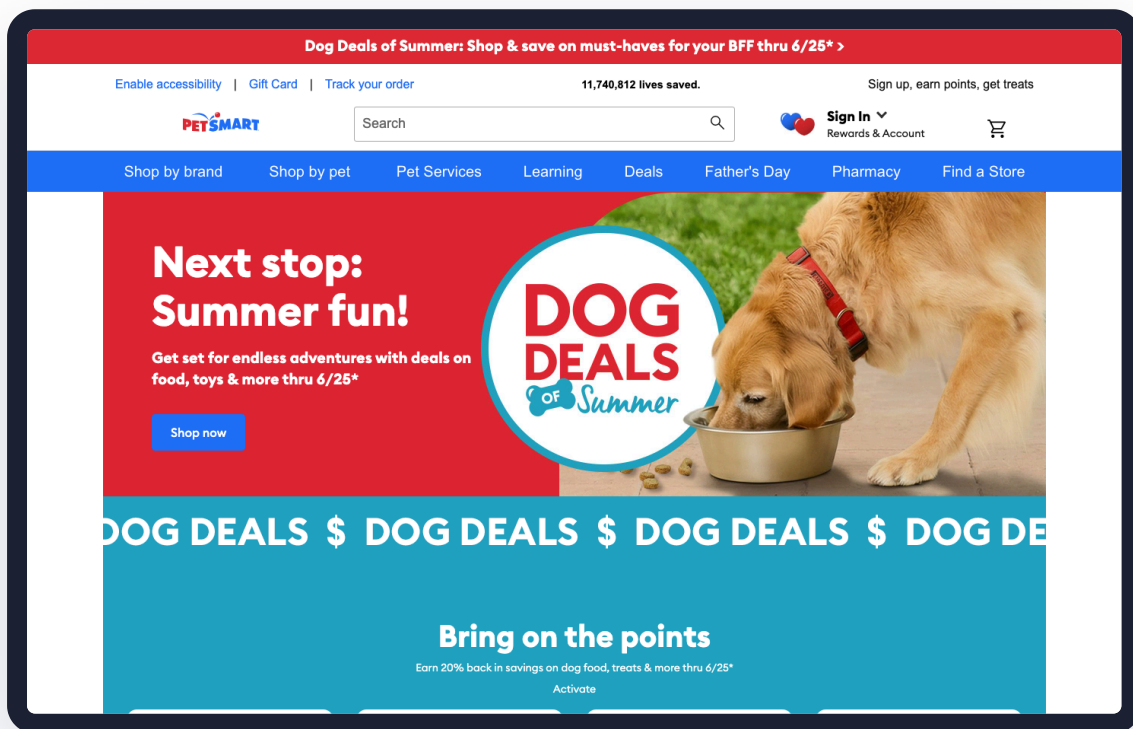




eCommerce Search Audit for

PetSmart



PREPARED FOR
PetSmart

PREPARED BY
Algolia

Leading retailers grow conversions and revenue with Algolia

REVIVAL ANIMAL HEALTH BIG W DECATHLON SINGAPORE

About Algolia

Over 17,000 brands use Algolia's AI search, discovery and recommendations platform to grow conversion and revenue. API first, it plugs into your existing stack, and it is the only end to end AI search that unifies keyword and vector retrieval behind one API.

About this document

We analyzed PetSmart's on site search, traffic and other available data. This report scores ten search areas, shows what we found with evidence, and lays out where activating Algolia has the most impact.

Why fast, intuitive discovery matters

~80%

of pet parents shop both online and in store. Search is the front door to the omnichannel basket. [Source: industry context](#)

1.8x

site searchers convert versus non searchers. The shoppers who search are your highest intent buyers.

[Industry Opportunity](#) ↗

81%

of US shoppers abandon after a failed search. Every dead end is a lost basket. [Industry Opportunity](#) ↗

Algolia delivers

+12% revenue conversions

Revival Animal Health

Closest pet-vertical proof point - a non-competing pet peer that lifted revenue conversions with Algolia, directly comparable to PetSmart's specialty-pet catalog. [case study](#) ↗

+7% search conversion

BIG W

Strongest large-format-retail peer on a headless React stack (like PetSmart's Next.js). Maps to F1 (NLP/exits), F3 (zero-results recovery), and F4 (basket/Recommend). [case study](#) ↗

+50% conversion

Decathlon Singapore

Upper-anchor proof for the personalization activation (F2) - a specialty omnichannel retailer that lifted conversion 50% with personalized search, the inert capability on PetSmart's userToken. [case study](#) ↗

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Search audit scorecard

5.8/10 **Strong Foundation, Unactivated Upside**
 0 critical · 5 moderate · 5 strengths

3/10 Semantic / NLP Search	4/10 Query Suggestions / Empty State
5/10 Content Commerce / Front-End UX	5/10 Dynamic Facets & Personalization
5/10 Recommendations & Merchandising	8/10 Intent Detection
8/10 Merchandising Consistency	9/10 Latency
9/10 Typo Tolerance	9/10 Search Intelligence

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Areas of improvement

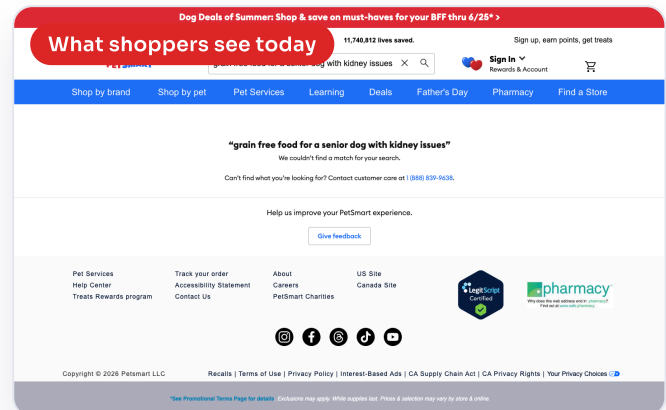
Conversational queries dead-end at zero results

A shopper searched **"grain free food for a senior dog with kidney issues"**

Pet parents increasingly search the way they talk ('grain free food for a senior dog with kidney issues'). Today those searches return nothing and the shopper leaves – a feature you already own can read that intent.

With Algolia Algolia NeuralSearch (hybrid keyword + vector semantic) on the existing p-US_products index – an upgrade, not a migration. Closes long-tail and conversational intent that keyword matching cannot parse.

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)



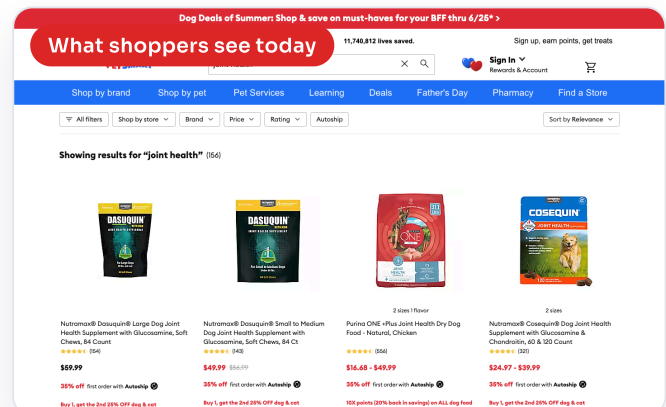
AI Personalization inert – userToken present, not re-ranking

A shopper searched **"joint health (anonymous vs dog-browsed session)"**

A shopper who has been browsing dog products still gets the same generic, dog-defaulted results as a brand-new visitor – the personalization signal you already collect isn't shaping what they see.

With Algolia Algolia AI Personalization + Dynamic Re-Ranking using the userToken/Insights data already flowing to App 97P6EWKR25 – consolidate three fragmented personalization vendors onto one surface.

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)



Areas of improvement, continued

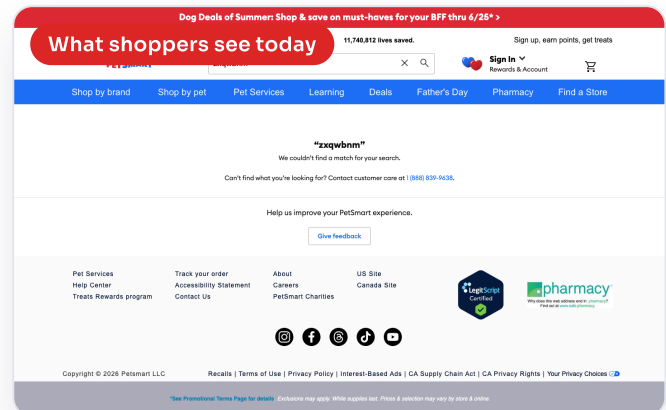
Zero-results null state is a bare dead-end

A shopper searched **"zxqwbnm (gibberish)"**

When search comes up empty, PetSmart shows a dead end and a phone number instead of helping the shopper find something else - the recovery tools (Query Suggestions, best-sellers) are already live in the search bar, just not on this page.

With Algolia Wire the existing Query Suggestions + Recommend best-sellers into the null state; add NeuralSearch so far fewer queries hit zero in the first place.

Source: PetSmart Algolia search analytics (30-day window)

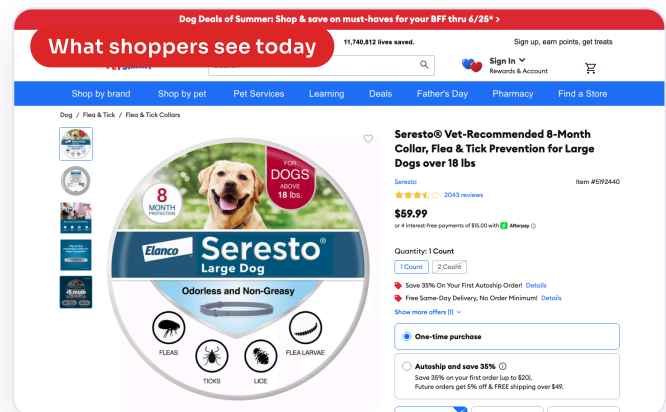


No Algolia Recommend cross-sell on results or PDP

A shopper searched **"flea and tick prevention (results + Seresto PDP)"**

When a shopper adds a flea collar, PetSmart doesn't surface the shampoo and home spray that complete the basket via the recommendation engine it already has access to.

With Algolia Algolia Recommend (Frequently Bought Together / Related Products / Trending) keyed off the same catalog + Insights events already in App 97P6EWKR25.



[algolia.com](https://www.algolia.com)

Areas of improvement, continued

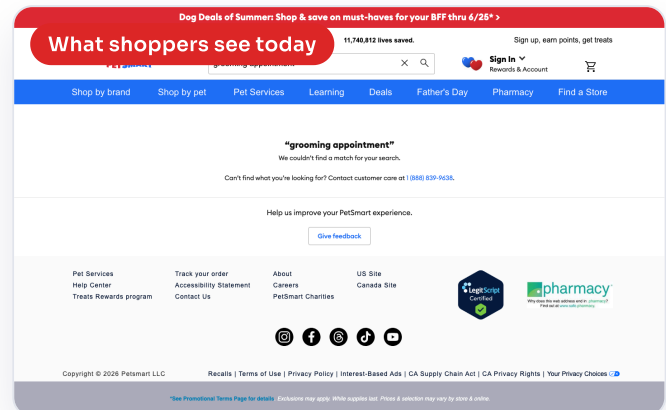
No federated content + services search (moat siloed)

A shopper searched **"return policy"**

The one thing Amazon and Chewy physically cannot offer - in-store grooming, training, vet - isn't findable from PetSmart's own search box, and neither is the help content shoppers ask for.

With Algolia Algolia Federated Search (multi-index: products + Contentful content + services) so the channel where PetSmart beats Amazon/Chewy is actually searchable.

nielseniq.com ↗



Where to start: a scoped proof of concept

Prove the lift on your live index in weeks, not quarters. A focused POC on the highest impact gap, measured against your own analytics.

1. **commercetools co-sell to CITO Fancher.** Engage Algolia's commercetools alliance team for a joint play: standardize PetSmart's existing Algolia deployment onto the native commercetools connector and pitch NeuralSearch activation to CITO Greg Fancher, who publicly champions an open plug-in platform. Lowest-friction, highest-leverage entry.
2. **Activate NeuralSearch + zero-results recovery.** Phase-1 quick win on the live p-US_products index: enable NeuralSearch and wire the existing Query Suggestions index into the zero-results null state. Low-risk config on App 97P6EWKR25, matches CITO's incremental buying philosophy. (F1, F3)
3. **Turn on AI Personalization + consolidate Recommend.** Activate AI Personalization + Dynamic Re-Ranking on the userToken/Insights data already flowing; move fragmented cross-sell (Granify/Einstein/Ordergroove) onto Algolia Recommend FBT. (F2, F4)
4. **Federate services + content, close web↔app parity.** Federate grooming/training/Banfield services + Contentful help content into search; standardize on the native commercetools connector; verify and close native-app AI-search parity. (F5)

Ready to scope it? Let's pick the first play together.